Welcome to the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence	Aug 18, 2025 9:09 AM	-

Hi Everyone,

Welcome to the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence. I'm thrilled to be teaching this course and excited about the upcoming semester.

Since the class is online and asynchronous, I'm reaching out now, before the term begins, to clarify exactly what you need to do to succeed.

The term starts on Monday, August 25th, and here's what I recommend doing on that day or the next one.

- Log onto MyCourses and click on the class (IDAI.700.02-Ethics of AI). I have uploaded everything you'll need for the entire semester, with one exception. You have to get your own copy of Hilke Schellmann's book *The Algorithm: How AI Decides Who Gets Hired, Monitored, Promoted, and Fired & Why We Need to Fight Back Now* (Hachette Book Group 2024, ISBN-13 9780306827341). Feel free to order it from whatever vendor offers you the best deal.

- Your next steps are to read the following documents: the syllabus, the independent research paper assignment, and the nine unit overviews (located in the Unit Overview folder). By reading these documents, you'll know what the class covers, what assignments you'll need to complete, when every assignment is due (and where to submit them), and how much each assignment is worth.

- Note: This course is designed with multiple pathways for learning. As outlined in each unit overview, you have been assigned various things to read and watch, and not everything is mandatory. In short, the extensive resources (ranging from video interviews with the authors you'll read, primary source material, video lectures, and PowerPoint slides) provide you with multiple opportunities to learn the fundamentals of AI ethics and flexibility as you chart your path forward.

After completing these preliminary tasks, here's what you should do next.

- As noted in the syllabus, RIT requires students enrolled in online courses to validate their IDs. To comply with university policy, please send me an e-mail and list a few days/times when you are available for a brief meeting on Zoom. We need to have the meeting before 6 pm on Friday, September 5th. During the meeting, please bring a photo ID that I can verify against the one stored in SIS. Although RIT mandates the process to ensure grading integrity, I'm looking forward to this opportunity to meet you.

- Create a schedule for yourself to complete Unit #1 AI & Ethics Fundamentals. As the unit outline states, it is due, in its entirety, by Sunday, September 14th.

If you have any questions, please don't hesitate to ask them. Otherwise, I'll see everyone soon on Zoom!

Best,
Evan

Assignment	Completion Status	Score	Evaluation Status
No Category			
Reflection Paper #1 (On Waelen's Ethics of Power) **Due on Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - September 14 **Attachments** Reflection Paper #1 (Waelen and Power).pdf (171.76 KB)	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Reflection Paper #2 (AI Ethics Skepticism) **Due on Oct 5, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - October 5 **Attachments** Reflection Paper #2 (Munn and Skepticism).pdf (152.61 KB)	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Reflection Paper #3 (On Banning Facial Recognition Technology) **Due on Oct 5, 2025 11:59 PM** September 1 - October 5	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Reflection Paper #4 (On AI and Hiring) **Due on Oct 26, 2025 11:59 PM** September 1 - October 26	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Reflection Paper #5 (AI Audits) **Due on Dec 7, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - December 7 **Attachments** Reflection Paper #5 (AI Adudits).docx (17.39 KB)	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Reflection Paper #6 (Black Box AI and Consent) **Due on Dec 7, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - December 7 **Attachments** Reflection Paper #6 (Blackbox AI and Consent).pdf (121.85 KB)	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Reflection Paper #7 (AI and Empathy) **Due on Dec 7, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - December 7 **Attachments** Reflection Paper #7 (AI and Empathy).pdf (125.39 KB)	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Reflection Paper #8 (The SOPHIE Project) **Due on Dec 7, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - December 7 **Attachments** Reflection Paper #8 (Sophie Project).pdf (126.18 KB)	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Reflection Paper #9 (Ethics of Designing Human-Like AI) **Due on Dec 7, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - December 7 **Attachments** Reflection Paper #9 (Ethics of Designing Human-... (143.96 KB)	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Research Portfolio **Due on Nov 10, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - November 10	Not Submitted	- / 100	
Research Paper **Due on Dec 10, 2025 11:59 PM** August 25 - December 10	Not Submitted	- / 100	

Discussions

Discussions List Subscriptions

Filter by: **Unread**

Post Your Question (Due November 14th)

Topic	Threads	Posts	Last Post
Post Your Question (Due November 14th)	0	0	

Help a Classmate (Due November 17th)

Topic	Threads	Posts	Last Post
Help a Classmate (Due November 17th)	0	0	

Post Your Portfolio Entry (Due November 19th)

Topic	Threads	Posts	Last Post
Post Your Portfolio Entry (Due November 19th)	0	0	

Provide Peer Feedback (Due November 24th)

Topic	Threads	Posts	Last Post
Provide Peer Feedback (Due November 24th)	0	0	

Ethics of AI
Independent Research
Prof. Evan Selinger

Overview

You will conduct independent research on one of five AI ethics topics that we either haven't covered in class or that expand on previous discussions. The assignment has three components, which collectively are worth 40% of the grade you will receive for this course.

- *Research Portfolio*: worth 40% of the independent research grade. It's due on November 10th in the Assignments section of MyCourses.

- *Collaborative Engagement*: worth 10% of the independent research grade. The engagement involves four posts to the MyCourses Discussion Board.

    - Post Your Question: 2.5% of research paper grade (Due November 14th).
    - Help a Classmate: 2.5% of research paper grade (Due November 17th).
    - Post Your Portfolio Entry: Required for feedback (Due November 19th).
    - Provide Peer Feedback: 5% of research paper grade (Due November 24th).

- *Research Paper (with AI Reflection Section)*: worth 50% of the independent research grade. It's due on December 10th in the Assignments section of MyCourses.

Learning Objectives

- Apply relevant ethical concepts, principles, and values to rigorously analyze current uses of AI.

- Carefully synthesize and critically evaluate peer-reviewed AI ethics scholarship.

- Construct a well-reasoned ethical argument that acknowledges the complexity of a research topic and thoughtfully respond to counterarguments to one's position.

- Engage constructively with classmates to refine one's ideas and provide meaningful, academically sound feedback to help them further their own research.

- Critically reflect on your experience of using AI during the independent research process and meaningfully connect what you learned to broader AI ethics issues.

Step #1: Pick a Research Topic

As early in the term as possible, choose *one* of the following five topics. Each one requires you to make a detailed, well-researched, and rational ethical argument.

Topic #1: AI Rights
Should AI ever have moral rights? Don't just argue yes or no. Consider what features or capabilities might justify AI deserving moral rights. For example, if AI becomes sentient, self-aware, or autonomous, should it have the right not to be destroyed or enslaved?

Topic #2: The Ethics of Military AI
Pick one specific military AI technology (autonomous weapons, surveillance, logistics coordination, etc.) that operates with a specific level of human oversight (e.g., requiring human approval for each action, only requiring human monitoring, or acting independently without human oversight, etc.). Argue whether the technology is, overall, being used ethically or unethically, making a detailed case for your conclusion. While you must reach a clear conclusion, your argument should acknowledge the complexity of the issue and address both the benefits and harms involved.

Topic #3: The Ethics of AI in Social Relationships
Pick one specific example where AI provides humans with a social relationship (e.g., as a companion, romantic partner, caregiver, etc.) and evaluate both the ethical benefits, risks, and harms. Most of your focus should be on evaluating the quality of the relationships—how AI companions affect human well-being, social skills, and connections with other people.

Topic #4: AI in Criminal Justice
Pick one specific AI application in criminal justice (e.g., risk assessment, predictive policing, sentencing, etc.) and argue whether the technology is, overall, being used ethically or unethically, making a detailed case for your conclusion. While you must reach a clear conclusion, your argument should acknowledge the complexity of the issue and address both the benefits and harms involved.

Topic #5 Alternative Option
If you have a compelling reason to conduct research on a different AI ethics topic, you may propose an alternative.

- Identify a specific AI ethics issue that we have not discussed in our course that is narrow enough to analyze deeply within the constraints of a 3,000-word paper.

- Verify that there is sufficient peer-reviewed literature on your topic (at least 6 articles available).

- Receive approval to proceed from me via email by November 3rd.

To propose an alternative topic, send me an email with (1) your proposed topic, (2) a brief but compelling explanation of why this topic interests you more than Topics #1-#4,

and (3) include three sample peer-reviewed sources that discuss the topic.

Step #2: Create a Research Portfolio (Due November 10th in the Assignments Section of MyCourses)
The portfolio is the foundation for your research paper. Think of it as an opportunity to build your knowledge base by considering expert perspectives before reaching any conclusions.

What You Need to Do

- Find 6 peer-reviewed AI ethics articles on your topic.
- For each article, write approximately 800 words that summarize and evaluate the author's main ethical arguments.
- By summarize, I mean explain what claims the author makes to develop an ethical argument and clarify how these claims are linked to form an argument.
- By evaluate, I mean provide a detailed account of why you find the author's arguments convincing or unpersuasive. You should use the first-person pronoun "I." For example, "I am not persuaded by Smith's analysis of X because of Y and Z."

What Doesn't Count

- Articles that only describe how a technology works or how people use it.
- Non-peer-reviewed sources (e.g., blog posts, news articles, etc.).
- Articles that don't include a robust ethical discussion.

Locating Peer-Reviewed Articles
The RIT library makes it easy to locate peer-reviewed material.

1. Go to https://www.rit.edu/library/.
2. Enter your search terms.
3. Click Search.
4. Click on the "Scholarly & Peer Reviewed" box.

Additional Help
If you are unsure whether an article is appropriate, please send me an e-mail. I'll provide constructive feedback to keep you on track.

Citations
Pick a standard citation format (MLA, APA, or Chicago) and use it consistently throughout your portfolio.

Late Penalty
-5 points per day.

Portfolio Grading Rubric

- Students selected quality sources that advance clear, thoughtful, and relevant ethical arguments (20%).

- Students provided a clear and rigorous summary that accurately explains the author's ethical arguments, evidence, and reasoning (40%).

- Students provided a clear and rigorous critical evaluation that analyzes the strengths, weaknesses, and persuasiveness of the author's ethical position (40%).

- Each portfolio entry should be approximately 800 words. Entries significantly under or over the recommended word count may receive point deductions.

- If a student selected an inappropriate source (e.g., not peer-reviewed or with low-quality ethical analysis), they will lose points and be asked to replace them.

Step #3: Share Research with Classmates (November 14th-17th)
After you've completed your research portfolio, you are ready to begin the collaborative engagement component of this assignment. This is an opportunity to create a research community that offers thoughtful peer feedback. Begin by sharing a research question with your classmates.

Step 3A: Post A Research Question on the MyCourses Discussion Board (Due November 14th)

What To Do
Write a post on the Discussion Board that poses a specific and significant question that your research portfolio motivated you to think about.

For example:

- "Three of my articles argue that predictive policing algorithms perpetuate racial bias. However, two others claim the bias comes from how human officers use the technology, not from the algorithms themselves. How should I evaluate these competing claims about where the ethical responsibility lies?"

- "One of my articles argues that AI companions reduce loneliness. However, another one argues that over time, the use of AI companions will make it harder for people to form human relationships. Both studies seem methodologically sound. How do I weigh short-term benefits against long-term harms?"

- "My military AI articles use different definitions of 'autonomy,' and these different definitions make a significant impact on the ethical claims each author presents. How should I address the lack of consistency?"

Step 3B: Help a Classmate (Due November 17th)

What To Do
Read one of your classmates' posts and respond thoughtfully to it on the Discussion Board. Prioritize responding to posts that haven't received responses. In your reply, be as specific and detailed as possible.

Step #4: Additional Peer Feedback (November 19th-24th)
Help a classmate improve their work by sharing one of your portfolio entries and providing constructive feedback on someone else's entry.

What To Do

- Post one of your completed portfolio entries along with the research article that you have summarized and evaluated to the Discussion Board (by November 19th).

- Choose one classmate's posted portfolio entry and provide approximately 400 words of helpful feedback (by November 24th).

What Your Feedback Should Focus On

- Is their summary of the article clear?

- Did they pick an article that makes useful points, given the research topic they chose?

- Is their assessment of the article clear?

- Is their assessment of the article thoughtful and detailed?

- Do you find their assessment of the article persuasive?

- Is anything important missing or underdeveloped in their ethical analysis?

- What's your favorite thing about their entry?

How to be Helpful

- Be specific ("Your explanation of the author's deontological argument needs more detail" vs. "This needs work").
- Suggest concrete improvements ("Try adding a sentence explaining why this ethical principle matters to your overall analysis").
- Be respectful and constructive.
- Focus on the ethical analysis, not writing style.

Late Penalty
Discussion posts submitted after deadlines will receive a -5 points deduction per day late (maximum 3 days late accepted). After 3 days, no credit will be given as the collaborative nature of these assignments requires timely participation.

Step #5: Write Your Research Paper (Due December 10th in the Assignments Section)

Basic Requirements

- Approximately 3,000 words (not including the AI Reflection).
- Present your ethical position on your chosen topic.
- In a logical and contextually appropriate manner, discuss (and cite) all 6 articles from your portfolio.
- Include a Counterargument section that presents and responds to the strongest possible objection to your own ethical position.
- Include an AI Reflection section (see below).

Ethical Position
You do not need to pick a single ethical framework for your analysis. Indeed, you may apply a variety of ethical concepts, principles, and values. What matters is that the ethical dimensions of your paper are crystal clear.

How to Structure Your Paper

1. **Introduction**
   What's your topic? Why does it have important ethical dimensions? And what's the main ethical position that you will advance?

2. **Background**
   What do the scholarly sources in your research portfolio say about this issue? What's your take on their positions? How have these articles informed your understanding of the ethical dimensions of the topic?

3. **Your Argument**
   In full detail, what's your ethical argument?

4. **Counterargument**
   Identify and respond to the strongest objection to your ethical position. Don't pick something easy to dismiss—choose the most compelling criticism someone might make. Then, you should either refute the objection or acknowledge how it reveals genuine limitations in your position (while explaining why your view remains stronger overall).

5. **Conclusion**
   Sum up your position and clarify its practical implications for individuals and society.

6. **AI Reflection**
   See the requirements below.

AI Reflection Section (approximately 300 words)
You must use a generative AI tool (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude, etc.) a few times while working on this assignment. Specifically, you should ask it relevant questions about your topic or your writing.

Be a Critical Thinker
You don't have to accept any AI suggestions. Indeed, you can reject anything it recommends!

In your reflection section, answer the following questions.

- How specifically did you use AI? (e.g., brainstorming, research help, editing, argument development, etc.).

- What did you learn about AI's abilities and limitations through this experience?

- Does your personal experience of using AI connect to the ethical issues you researched or that we covered in class? What, if any, insights does this provide about AI's role in academic work, research, or society?

- Did this experience change your perspective on any aspect of AI ethics?

Citation and Sources

Use the same standard citation format (MLA, APA, or Chicago) throughout your paper. When you mention someone else's ideas or include a passage from their writing, give them credit with proper citations.

Final Paper Grading Rubric

- Students presented a well-reasoned, clearly developed ethical position with strong supporting evidence (35%).
- Students effectively integrated summary and evaluation material from all 6 research portfolio sources (35%).
- Students effectively presented and responded to a compelling counterargument (10%).
- The AI Engagement Reflection demonstrated a thoughtful connection between personal AI use and course concepts (10%).
- The student's writing was clear, logical, and demonstrated graduate-level academic expression (10%).

Late Penalty

-5 points per day. Papers not submitted by December 16th will receive a 0.

Emergency Extensions

If an emergency arises, I will grant an extension for any component of this assignment, so long as you contact me before it is due.

Without Category	Evaluation Status	Attempts
Quiz #1 (Suleyman and Aguilar interview) Due on Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #2 (Ethics Part 1, Rights and Utilitarianism) Due on Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #3 (Ethics Part 2, The Common Good, Virtue Ethics, and Care Ethics) Due on Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #4 ("An Overview of Artificial Intelligence Ethics") Due on Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #5 (Waelen on Power and CV) Due on Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Sep 14, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #6 (Munn on AI Ethics Skepticism) Due on Oct 5, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Oct 5, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #7 (Jay Stanley and AI Surveillance) Due on Oct 5, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Oct 5, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #8 (Hartzog, Selinger, and Rhee on Banning Facial Recognition Technology) Due on Oct 5, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Oct 5, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #9 (Schellmann Chapters 1-4) Due on Oct 26, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Oct 26, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #10 (Schellmann Chapters 5-8) Due on Oct 26, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Oct 26, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1
Quiz #11 (Ethics of Human-Like AI) Due on Dec 7, 2025 11:59 PM Available on Aug 25, 2025 12:01 AM until Dec 7, 2025 11:59 PM		0 / 1

Ethics of Artificial Intelligence

Course: *IDAI 700-02*
Semester: *Fall 2025*
Times: *Asynchronous*
Location: *Online*

Instructor: *Dr. Evan Selinger*
Office: *Eastman (EAS) 3146*
E-mail: *evan.selinger@rit.edu*
Zoom: *https://rit.zoom.us/my/emsgsh*
Phone: *585-475-2531*
Office Hours: *By Appointment*

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This graduate course introduces students to foundational concepts and emerging ideas in the ethics of artificial intelligence. As an online, asynchronous course, it is designed to provide multiple pathways for learning and give students the flexibility they need to understand this material in the way that works best for them. The course is divided into nine units, and it also requires students to conduct independent research in AI ethics. For each unit, you'll find a Unit Overview document that lists what you should watch and read, and what assignments you'll need to complete and when they are due.

COURSE MATERIAL

Nearly everything you need for the course can be found on MyCourses: the Unit Overviews, my interviews with the authors you'll be reading, my lectures, my PowerPoint slides, and most the required readings. The only thing you'll need to buy, and I recommend doing so right away, is Hilke Schellmann's book *The Algorithm: How AI Decides Who Gets Hired, Monitored, Promoted, and Fired & Why We Need to Fight Back Now* (Hachette Book Group 2024, ISBN-13 9780306827341).

VALIDATING YOUR ID

Since this is an online course, RIT requires students to validate their IDs. To comply with policy, please send me an e-mail as soon as the course begins and list a few days/times that you are available for a brief meeting on Zoom. We need to have the meeting before 6 pm on Friday, September 5th. During the meeting, you'll need to bring a photo ID that I can compare with the one stored in SIS. Although RIT mandates the process to ensure grading integrity, I'm looking forward to this opportunity to get to know you and answer any questions you may have about the course.

MAIN LEARNING GOALS

- Introduce students to central topics in AI ethics, with some attention to AI policy.
- Familiarize students with the practice of making theoretical and applied claims about AI ethics, including arguments, that professionals will recognize as thoughtful and well-supported.
- Introduce students to the rigors of conducting independent, graduate-level AI ethics research.

OFFICE HOURS
There are many convenient ways for us to discuss the course. Please reach out via e-mail and let me know if you'd like to have a conversation there, on Zoom, or over the phone. I aim to reply within 36 hours (weekdays) and 48 hours (weekends and holidays). So, please plan accordingly.

GRADED ASSIGNMENTS

- *Quizzes are worth 30% of the final grade*. There are 11 open book quizzes, distributed across many of the units, and your lowest quiz grade will be automatically dropped. You will take the quizzes in the Quizzes section of MyCourses, and the due dates for each quiz are listed in the Unit Overviews. All Unit Overviews are on MyCourses.

- *Reflection Papers are worth 30% of the final grade*. There are 9 reflection papers, distributed across many of the units, and your lowest grade will be automatically dropped. The instructions for each one can be found in the Assignments section of MyCourses, and the due dates for each Reflection Paper are listed in the Unit Overviews. All Unit Overviews are on MyCourses.

- *Independent Research Paper is worth 40% of the final grade.* It has several components (research portfolio, collaborative engagement, and research paper) and all the specifics, including the due dates, can be found in the "Independent Research Paper" document on MyCourses.

GRADE VERIFICATION

- After each assignment, it is your responsibility to ensure that the correct grade is uploaded to MyCourses. If any mistakes arise, please bring them to my attention immediately so they can be rectified. It will not be permissible to revisit grades for past assignments at the end of the term.

GRADE SCHEME & FINAL GRADES

- 93.00-100 A
- 90-92 A-
- 87-89 B+
- 83-86 B
- 80.00-82 B-
- 77.00-79 C+
- 73.00-76 C
- 70.00-72 C-
- 60.00-69 D

- Final grades are not automatically rounded up. Borderline grades will be determined at the professor's discretion, considering factors such as the student's grades improving over the course of the term.

- Incomplete (I) grades will only be given for documented emergencies cleared by the Director of the AI program.

Academic Integrity and LLM Policy

- Academic integrity is a prerequisite for all RIT courses. Appropriate disciplinary measures— potentially including being given a failing grade for the course—will be taken if anyone is found cheating. Plagiarism, the act of presenting other people's (or machine-generated) writing or ideas as your own, will be considered cheating. Your rights and responsibilities as a member of Rochester Institute of Technology's academic community can be found here.

- The LLM policy for this class is straightforward. You are not allowed to use LLMs when taking quizzes or writing the Reflection Papers. However, you are required to use an LLM when conducting your Independent Research. That assignment has an AI Reflection Section, and the instructions specify exactly how you should use the tool and document your activity.

DISABILITIES

- RIT is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to students with disabilities. If you would like to request accommodations, please contact the Disability Services Office. It's located in the Student Alumni Union, Room 1150. For more information, go here.

EMERGENT CHANGES TO THE COURSE

Course requirements, assignment deadlines, readings, viewings, and grading procedures may need to be adjusted as the semester progresses. Any changes will be communicated via MyCourses and e-mail. You are responsible for regularly checking the e-mail address listed in MyCourses and staying informed about any updates.

IMPORTANT GENERAL DATES

- First Day of Class: August 25th
- Fall Break: October 13th - 14th
- Thanksgiving: November 26th – 28th
- Last Day of Class: December 8th

DUE DATES FOR UNITS

All assignments for Units #1 - #3 are due by the end of the day on Sunday, September 14th. The assignments are listed in the Unit Overviews on MyCourses.

Unit #1 AI & Ethics Fundamentals

This unit provides a foundation for thinking critically about AI and understanding the basic dimensions of ethical reasoning in the Western philosophical tradition.

Unit #2 AI Ethics Essentials
This unit provides a foundation for understanding AI ethics.

Unit #3 AI Ethics and Power
This unit provides a foundation for understanding how AI ethics issues are related to concerns about power.

All assignments for Units #4 - #5 are due by the end of the day on Sunday, October 5th. The assignments are listed in the Unit Overviews on MyCourses.

Unit #4 AI Ethics Skepticism
This unit covers the main reasons critics are skeptical about AI ethics.

Unit #5 AI Ethics and Bans
This unit examines the most extreme position in AI ethics: the complete prohibition of certain technologies. We will explore whether technology bans are ever justified or if they represent an overreach that stifles innovation and beneficial uses. To ground these abstract questions in concrete policy discussions, this unit focuses specifically on the ongoing debate about facial recognition technology.

All assignments for Unit #6 are due by the end of the day on Sunday, October 26th. The assignments are listed in the Unit Overview on MyCourses.

Unit #6 AI Ethics in Hiring and Work
This unit examines how AI is transforming hiring and workplace practices. This is an applied unit that brings AI ethics into practice through real-world case studies and investigative findings. By analyzing specific AI applications in recruitment and employee management, we will deepen our understanding of fundamental AI ethics issues that are relevant across many contexts and introduce the problem of dehumanization.

All assignments for Units #7-#9 are due on Sunday, December 7th. The assignments are listed in the Unit Overviews on MyCourses.

Unit #7 AI Ethics and Audits
This unit is an introduction to the emerging field of AI audits—what they are, why they matter, and the complex challenges involved in implementing them effectively. Through examining real-world examples and expert perspectives, students will gain insight into how auditing serves as a critical tool for responsible AI governance while recognizing its limitations and ongoing debates about best practices.

Unit #8 AI Ethics and Healthcare
This unit examines some of the ways that AI is transforming healthcare and the complex ethical challenges this transformation creates. By exploring issues of informed consent, the debate over

whether AI can achieve genuine empathy, and practical scenarios for using AI to improve medical communication, we will deepen our understanding of core AI ethics concepts.

Unit #9 AI Ethics and Human-Like Design

This unit explores the ethics of designing AI systems with human-like features, examines why these design choices matter, and critically evaluates various approaches to anthropomorphic design, including the precautionary approach.